

Gods and Soup Bowls

Questions about the unknown
edges of
time, the ones that lap

against the two sides of a
life,
form most often in misshapen

heads. He knows this best when
wrapped
in the currency of her warm-

breathing body, speaking softly of
gods, soup
bowls, and other things too.

For her, there is no need for a
cloud-shaped
song-singer coughing up

stars, a He to grant laws and right
angles and
each object its individual weight.

For her, there is everything
else: the machinery
of her own body, the springiness of

a bed frame, her mother's shoes;
there is the future,
the promise of becoming spooled

out in delicate and glittering
reels, asked for
and granted by the earth itself.

For him, the marvelous is not
absent, but it
does not anneal into long chains.

For him, there are only the
questions asked
pressed against a closed window;

there is a permanent sheen of
raindrops, iciest
hums, there is the sense

of being caught within a breath.
Without Him,
there is only a predawn cry,

a howling out of: *patchwork-
framework of
things that I have won* –

will you lift me up?